MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 7/15/26 IW

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
June 17, 2026

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

None

OTHERS PRESENT

Administrator Lori Phelps, Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger, Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Gross to approve the agenda, **Motion carried.**

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of May 20, 2026, **Motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

None

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

Resolution Opposing Michigan Constitutional Amendment that would disenfranchise Ingham County Citizens - No discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps provided the Commissioners with updates from the Michigan Association of Counties regarding county funding and transportation issues. As the county approaches the fiscal year's final quarter, the remaining annual expenditure budget should be around 29.17% and it is currently at 37.43%. She recently attended the Michigan Indigent Defense Commission (MIDC) meeting and formally requested a contract amendment and additional funding to address the MIDC program overage. The MIDC did approve an additional over $600,000.00 in funding for the current fiscal year.

Administrator Phelps reported that Fiscal Year 2027 budget preparation is underway. She has met with most department heads to review operational needs, staffing considerations, capital requests and budget priorities. The county's health insurance renewal has returned with a significant proposed increase; therefore, Administrator Phelps is evaluating alternative options. Additionally, Materials Management Planning continues to require a significant amount of staff time. The Clare County workgroup is collecting and compiling data, developing preliminary goals, benchmarks and implementation strategies. Administrator Phelps announced that she is scheduled to meet with Gladwin County officials next week to discuss the shared court budgets and ongoing cost sharing arrangements.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

None

JUSTICE

1. Emergency Management – Homeland Security
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the Hazardous Materials Emergency Preparedness (HMEP) Hazardous Materials grant from the State of Michigan in the amount of $1,650.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

2. Michigan Indigent Defense Commission (MIDC)
   It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the grant amendment to the FY26 grant agreement with the Michigan Indigent Defense Commission with an increased amount of $662,759.23, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

None

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Equalization
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the L-4029, Tax Rate Request in the amount of $1,625,911,594.00 (One Billion, Six Hundred Twenty Five Million, Nine Hundred Eleven Thousand, Five Hundred Ninety Four Dollars) which is the maximum allowable millage levy of 4.6236, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Fancon, Gross, Hoefling, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Haskell and Housler
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

2. Drain Lake Level
   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve Resolution #26-12, Bertha Lake, Lake Level Resolution Pursuant to MCL 324.30701 for maintenance and improvements expected to exceed $10,000.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Haskell to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of May 26, 2026 in the amount of $95,212.90 and the meeting minutes of June 8, 2026 in the amount of $168,842.35, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Hoefling, Housler, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Gross and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the expenditures for the month of May, 2026 in the amount of $2,698,266.75 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,423,280.44, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

3. Budget Adjustments
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve Budget Adjustment #26-99 in the amount of $468,569.50 and Budget Adjustment #26-105 in the amount of $910,511.01, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Housler, Fancon, Gross, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Hoefling, Kleinhardt, Haskell and Gilmore
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

4. Brownfield
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Housler to allow the County to pay off the balance of the Brownfield loan not to exceed $40,000.00, contingent upon the sale/transfer of the HAEDCO Property to the Clare County Land Bank, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Gross, Hoefling, Kleinhardt, Haskell, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore and Housler
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners. She noted that the general fund balance is low; however the third quarter is when the general fund receives the majority of its money.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman George Gilmore has attended his meetings and everything is going well with his townships.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Rick Fancon had no report.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Hoefling has attended his meetings and gave a report on each of the townships and committees he represents.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis attended the Mill Pond opening in Farwell and Midterm Commissioners training at Kirkland College, stating both events were well done.

Commissioner Housler asked for an update regarding counts for spongy moths but had no report.

Commissioner Kleinhardt commented on recent road worker deaths encouraging drivers to slow down but had no report.

Commissioner Haskell reported that the Central Michigan District Health Department's Director Steve Hall resigned and they are looking for his replacement.

Commissioner Gross stated that he will be attending the Mid State Substance Use Policy Board meeting in Lansing but had no report.

Commissioner Majewski reported that Lincoln Township is hosting a kick off for Bertha Lakes on June 19, 2026 at 11 a.m. Shingle Lake Park's construction is underway and is scheduled to be complete end of September. Additionally, Commissioner Majewski announced his retirement as Clare County District 2 Commissioner effective July 3, 2026.

PUBLIC COMMENT

A Clare County resident apologized to the Board for his actions at the previous Board of Commissioners' meeting. He expressed frustration that other speakers are permitted to exceed the three-minute public comment limit, while he is consistently stopped when he reaches the allotted three minutes. He also made a recommendation that the Board of Commissioners resume the Committee of the Whole meetings.

Sheriff John Wilson, Administrator Lori Phelps and Commissioner Marlene Housler expressed gratitude towards Commissioner Majewski for his service to Clare County.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

1. Interviews
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Housler to have interviews for the vacant Commissioner's position on July 7, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. and if needed on July 8, 2026 at 1:00 p.m., **Motion carried.**

ADJOURNMENT

It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to adjourn, **motion carried.**

Meeting adjourned at 9:41 a.m.

Isha Walter, Deputy Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners